

Southeast Europe

UNTIL 1991, CROATIA, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Serbia, Montenegro, and Macedonia were all part of Yugoslavia. Ethnic tensions between the Serbs and other peoples in Yugoslavia caused a series of bloody wars that broke up the country. Peace was eventually restored in 1999, but all five countries have suffered intense economic problems as a result. So, too, has Albania since its communist government collapsed. The six nations do, however, have huge potential, with considerable agricultural and mineral resources. In the north, the Danube River is an important trading route for both Croatia and Serbia, while Croatia has a flourishing tourist industry along its beautiful Adriatic coast.

SPORTING ACHIEVEMENT

Croatia is a great sporting nation. Former skier Janica Kostelić has won four Olympic gold medals (three in 2002 and one in 2006), making her one of the most successful female Alpine skiers of all time. Other popular sports are football (soccer), tennis, and basketball.



The Dalmatian dog is named after the coastal region of Dalmatia in Croatia, its first known home.

THE ADRIATIC

The long Adriatic coastline of Croatia is one of the most beautiful in Europe. The wooded hillsides, pretty beaches, such as Markarska (right), islands, and historic towns such as Dubrovnik attract tourists from all over Europe. The archipelago is also popular for sailing holidays.



GROWING FOOD
The most fertile area in this region lies along the River Danube in northern Serbia and eastern Croatia. Here, vegetables, fruit, corn, and cereals are grown, as well as grapes for wine-making. Most farms are small-scale family businesses growing a wide range of crops.

DIFFERENT SCRIPTS

Croatian and Serbian languages are very similar but the people of Croatia, a predominantly Roman Catholic country, write in Roman script, as do Bosnians. Serbians are mainly Eastern Orthodox and write using both Roman and Russian Cyrillic scripts.



Magazine with Roman script

Magazine with Cyrillic script

